

Cover Supervisor – Primary

Cover Supervisors at Leigh Academies Trust are integral to maintaining educational continuity by overseeing classes during the short-term absence of teachers. They are responsible for fostering a positive and engaging learning environment, delivering pre-planned lesson instructions, managing student behaviour, and encouraging active participation in learning activities. While the role does not involve planning, preparation, or assessment, Cover Supervisors offer valuable assistance by responding to student queries, providing feedback to teachers, and undertaking general administrative duties when not directly covering a class.

Core Purpose

The central aim of the Cover Supervisor is to provide a safe and structured learning environment, enabling young learners to continue their education when their regular teacher is unavailable. This is achieved by delivering clear instructions, effectively managing behaviour, and ensuring students remain focused on assigned tasks. They serve as positive role models, upholding high standards of conduct and supporting the academy's commitment to delivering a consistent and inclusive educational experience for all students.

Key Areas of Responsibility

1. Supervising Learning Activities

- Supervise students engaged in learning activities, ensuring that the learning objectives set by the teacher are met.
- Promote inclusion and acceptance of all students to foster equal opportunities within the classroom.
- Deliver clear instructions for the lesson as provided by the teacher, ensuring that learning outcomes are achieved.
- Support the appropriate use of ICT and other equipment and materials to enable students to achieve the learning objectives set by the teacher.

2. Managing Behaviour and the Learning Environment

- Act as a role model and set high expectations of conduct to ensure that good behaviour is consistently maintained.
- Ensure that learning objectives are achieved by the students within a safe and secure environment. This includes proactively addressing minor disruptions and maintaining a positive atmosphere conducive to learning.

3. Communication and Feedback

- Respond effectively to students' general questions related to the lesson content..

- Maintain appropriate records, as agreed with the teacher, to enable objective and accurate feedback to both the teacher and students on the conduct and progress of the lessons. This feedback is crucial for supporting ongoing student development.

Adherence to Policies and Procedures

- Be acutely aware of and comply with all academy policies and procedures relating to child protection, equal opportunities, health, safety, security, confidentiality, and data protection.
- Report any concerns to the appropriate person, to consistently maintain a safe and secure learning environment for students.

5. Professional Development and Wider Responsibilities

- Actively participate in training and other learning activities as required to ensure your own continuing professional development.
- Attend relevant meetings to stay informed and contribute to the collaborative spirit of the academy.
- During periods when no cover is required, Cover Supervisors will provide valuable support to the academy with general administrative duties as requested. This flexibility is essential for the smooth operation of the academy.
- Engage actively and constructively in the Performance Management Review process.
- Evaluate own personal performance through self-evaluation and learn from the effective practice of others and from evidence.

6. Professional Values and Practice

- Support the Academy's responsibility to provide and monitor opportunities for the personal and academic growth of students.
- Provide a positive role model through exemplary personal and professional conduct.
- Work effectively as a member of designated teams and contribute positively to effective working relations within the Academy.
- Be proficient in the application of literacy and numeracy skills, setting a good example for students.
- Safeguard the health and safety of all students both on the Academy premises and when engaged in authorised Academy activities elsewhere.
- Actively contribute to the effective running of the Academy as a whole.



Person Specification – Cover Supervisor (Primary)

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes for the Cover Supervisor role in a Primary School:

Qualifications and Training

Essential:

- Educated to GCSE level standard or equivalent (English and Maths A*–C grade or equivalent).

Desirable:

- An Undergraduate Education Degree or a degree in any subject, indicating a higher level of academic qualification.

Experience

Essential:

- Working within an educational setting, demonstrating familiarity with the school environment and routines.
- Working with children who have special educational needs and disabilities, promoting inclusive practices and supporting diverse learning needs.

Desirable:

- Experience in overseeing lessons and managing a classroom, providing a proven ability to maintain order and facilitate learning.

Knowledge and Understanding

Essential:

- Basic understanding of the National Key Stage Curriculum, providing a framework for supervising learning activities across different subjects.
- Knowledge of child development and learning, enabling effective interaction with students of various ages and abilities.
- Knowledge of relevant policies, codes of practice and legislation, including safeguarding, to ensure a safe and compliant learning environment.

Desirable:

- Understanding of effective behaviour management strategies, promoting a positive and productive learning environment.
- Knowledge of common special educational needs and how they may affect learning, enabling inclusive support for all students.

Skills and Abilities

Essential:

- Skills to self-evaluate your own learning needs, demonstrating a commitment to continuous professional development.

- Strong communication skills, enabling clear instruction-giving and effective interaction with students and staff.
- Ability to work effectively as a member of staff, providing support to the faculty and contributing to a positive team environment.
- Ability to oversee a wide range of lessons, demonstrating adaptability and a willingness to supervise diverse subject areas.
- Confidence to manage a class of mixed-ability pupils, maintaining order and promoting engagement for all learners.
- Ability to keep students focused and on task, minimising disruption and maximising learning time.
- Ability to provide constructive feedback that encourages pupils' positive self-esteem, promoting a supportive and motivating learning atmosphere.

Desirable:

- Strong ICT skills, enabling the effective use of technology to support learning and manage classroom activities.
- Ability to adapt communication style to suit different age groups and abilities, ensuring clear and effective interaction with all students.
- Ability to demonstrate initiative and problem-solve, proactively addressing issues that may arise during cover lessons.

Personal Qualities

The Cover Supervisor will be a **reliable, responsible, and adaptable individual** with a genuine passion for supporting student learning. They will possess **strong communication** and **interpersonal skills**, enabling them to build **positive relationships** with students, colleagues, and parents alike. The Cover Supervisor will be **confident** in managing classroom behaviour, **consistently ensuring a safe and productive learning environment** for all. They will demonstrate an **unwavering commitment to professionalism**, adhering strictly to academy policies and procedures, and actively engaging in their own professional development. Furthermore, they will be **empathetic and understanding**, able to handle sensitive situations with **tact and discretion**, and dedicated to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of all children.



Safeguarding of Students and Duty of Care

All staff, regardless of role, level of seniority and location, have a responsibility to ensure the highest levels of safeguarding and promoting the welfare of our pupils, and we expect all our staff and volunteers to share this commitment. We must collectively create an environment where children feel safe to learn, play, and grow. Children should feel comfortable in their surroundings and know that they can approach any responsible adult with any problems or concerns.

All staff must be able to identify any children who are at risk of harm, and know the characteristics of abuse or neglect. If you suspect or confirm harm then it's essential you know what actions to take.

Annual safeguarding training is offered to all staff at Leigh Academies Trust, and it is the staff member's responsibility to be aware of the most up to date guidance documented in the [Keeping Children Safe in Education document](#) (Department of Education).

Notes

The job description allocates duties and responsibilities but does not direct the particular amount of time to be spent on carrying them out and no part of it may be so construed. This job description is not necessarily a comprehensive definition of the post. It will be reviewed at least once a year and may be subject to modification or amendment at any time after consultation with the holder of the post.

The duties may be varied to meet the changing demands of the academy/business unit at the reasonable discretion of the Principal/Director. This job description does not form part of the contract of employment. It describes the way the post-holder is expected and required to perform and complete the particular duties as set out in the foregoing.